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RFK Jr. urges measles vaccine for kids

In shift, health chief says shots protect communities in wake of Texas outbreak

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Amid a growing outbreak of measles in Texas, recently confirmed Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. is urging parents to vaccinate their children against the disease.

While such a recommendation would usually be unremarkable for a secretary of Health and Human Services Department, it was a nota-

ble one from Kennedy, who has spent years casting doubt on the safety and reliability of that vaccine and others, despite the enormous body of evidence that supports their safe and effective use.

Kennedy published an op-ed on Fox News on Sunday urging parents to consider the measles, mumps, and rubella (MMR) vaccine for their children, laying out the benefits of vaccination and tell-

ing families to consult with their doctors.

“The decision to vaccinate is a personal one,” Kennedy wrote. “Vaccines not only protect individual children from measles, but also contribute to community immunity, protecting those who are unable to be vaccinated due to medical reasons.”

He also advised a balanced diet, saying “good nutrition remains a best defense against most chronic and infectious illnesses.”

The outbreak in western Texas has infected at least 146 people,

most of whom were unvaccinated and under age 18, and one unvaccinated child has died. It is the first measles-related death in the United States in a decade. Measles was declared eliminated from the country in 2000, defined as the absence of continuous spread of the disease. But vaccination rates among children have been declining as misinformation and mistrust of public health measures have grown. A 95 percent vaccination rate is required to collectively reach herd immunity against measles in a population;

KENNEDY, Page A6

Tariffs set to target Canada, Mexico

Trump rejects efforts by both countries on drugs, migrants as insufficient

By Ana Swanson, Simon Romero, and Ian Austen

NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump said Monday sweeping tariffs on Canada and Mexico would go into effect Tuesday, stating in remarks at the White House there was no chance for a last-minute deal to avert the levies.

“The tariffs, you know, they’re all set,” Trump said. “They go into effect tomorrow.”

►Stocks tumble on news of tariffs. D1.

Trump has proposed adding a 25 percent fee on all Mexican and Canadian exports coming across those borders and an additional 10 percent for Chinese goods, beginning just after midnight Tuesday, saying those countries have not done enough to stem the flow of drugs and migrants into the United States.

The move will increase the levies that the United States charges on foreign goods to levels not seen at least since the 1940s and is likely to shatter regional supply chains and raise the cost of products ranging from automobiles to breast pumps and vegetables.

The tariffs are also expected to further deteriorate

TARIFFS, Page A7

Energy levy could wallop Northeast

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Almost every day, trucks from Fred’s Energy trundle north across the border into Canada to pick up loads of home-heating oil, diesel, kerosene, and propane for the company’s customers in northern Vermont.

Starting Tuesday, those customers will pay a premium on such products, with President Trump confirming Monday he would impose 10 percent tariffs on energy imported from Canada starting at midnight.

“I’m very concerned,” said Dennis Percy, general manager of Fred’s Energy, a locally owned company that serves around 15,000 customers. “It’s just another tax. We’re getting taxed to death.”

Canada supplies a significant portion of the electricity, refined petroleum, and natural gas used in New England. Customers who live near the border are particularly dependent on Canadian energy, while farther south in Massachusetts, ratepayers are dealing with soaring utility bills that the tariffs would only exacerbate.

“We are interconnected, integrated, and Canadian resources are an essential and vital part of New England’s overall energy supply system,” said John Gulliver, a retired energy attorney from Maine who serves as president of the New England-Canada Business Council.

CANADA, Page A7

A winter wondering land



BOSTON GLOBE PHOTO

Climate change is giving New England its own version of seasonal affective disorder

By Erin Douglas and Ken Mahan

GLOBE STAFF

Finally. We watched snowflakes glimmer in the light of street lamps. Kids played pick-up hockey on frozen ponds. And skiers relished the abundant snow cover — a booming ski season was back.

After years of warm winters that limited snow sports and often left the ground muddy instead of blanketed by white, New Englanders this year welcomed back a winter season that felt, well, cold.

This more classic New England winter is thanks to a weak La Niña weather pattern that tends to draw in more cold air and help whip up storms. Even so, this winter doesn’t come close to the hallmark bitter cold winters of Boston: Temperatures trended below average but were generally well within what’s considered normal. And the snowfall in Boston was actually below average between December and late February.

New England winters are now 3 degrees warmer,

WINTER, Page A5



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

At top, children sledded down a hill on Boston Common on a snowy February day in 1940. Above, Henry Capstick slapped water along with the hockey puck while on the slushy Boston Public Garden lagoon in late December.

NET WORKING



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

Teams from across the country, and even from as far away as Brazil, converged on the Boston Exhibition and Convention Center last month for a volleyball tourney. Ninety-one courts hosted 1,486 teams with about 20,000 athletes. **As I See It, B1.**

Kraft takes unique spin on rent control

Proposal is bid to stake out ground on key mayoral issue

By Andrew Brinker

GLOBE STAFF

On the day he launched his mayoral campaign, Josh Kraft went on the offensive, assailing Mayor Michelle Wu over her record on bike lanes and housing construction. That was no surprise.

But one avenue of attack raised eyebrows across the city. Kraft said he would make good on a progressive policy promise that Wu had tried but failed: Bringing rent control back to Boston.

“Mayor Wu promised us rent control three years ago,” Kraft said. “We will deliver it finally.”

That Kraft, the son of billionaire Patriots owner Robert Kraft and a favored candidate in some corners of the business community, would lean into an issue that many economists believe does more harm than good and most land-

KRAFT, Page A10

US halts Kyiv aid

President Trump temporarily suspended the delivery of all military aid to Ukraine. **A3.**

Arab leaders, facing a faltering cease-fire, are working to develop their own plan for the future of the enclave. **A4.**

A shift in US approach has affected the Fulbright Program, which sends scholars abroad. **B1.**

The state revealed regulations to better protect consumers from being scammed through junk fees. **D1.**



At the bitter end

Tuesday: Much warmer. High 45-50, low 38-43.

Wednesday: Mercury still up. High 54-59, low 45-50.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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